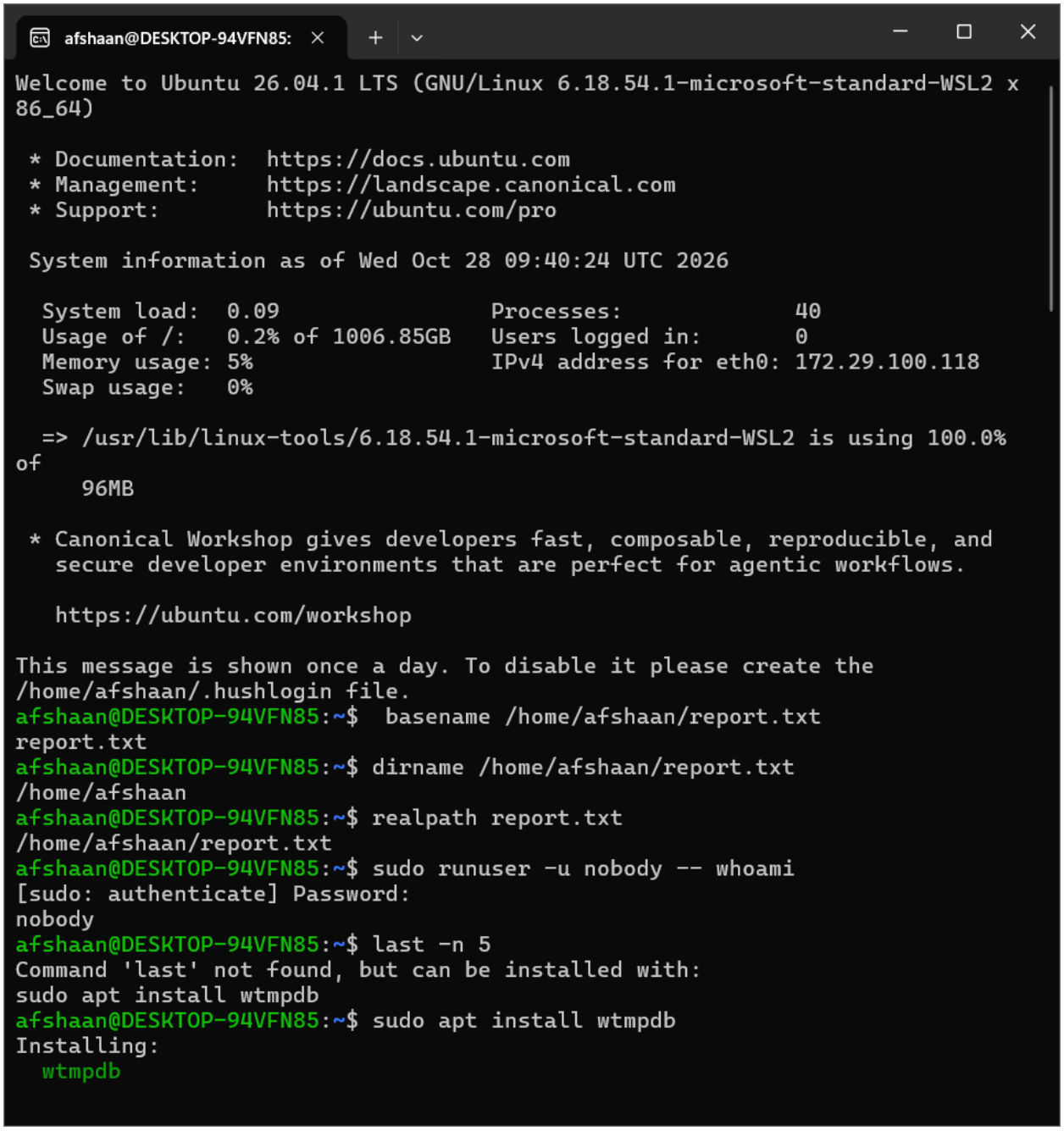
10 Linux commands

No.	Command	What it does	Practice example
1	basename	Extracts the filename from a path	basename /home/afshaan/report.txt
2	dirname	Extracts the directory from a path	dirname /home/afshaan/report.txt
3	realpath	Displays the absolute path of a file	realpath report.txt
4	runuser	Runs a command as another user	sudo runuser -u nobody -- whoami
5	last	Displays recent login sessions	last -n 5
6	lastlog	Displays users' most recent login information	lastlog
7	w	Shows logged-in users and their activity	w
8	watch	Repeats a command at regular intervals	watch -n 2 date
9	pstree	Displays processes in a tree structure	pstree -p
10	lscpu	Displays CPU architecture and processor information	lscpu


afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:
Welcome to Ubuntu 26.04.1 LTS (GNU/Linux 6.18.54.1-microsoft-standard-WSL2 x 86_64)
* Documentation: https://docs.ubuntu.com
* Management: https://landscape.canonical.com
* Support: https://ubuntu.com/pro
System information as of Wed Oct 28 09:40:24 UTC 2026
System load: 0.09
Usage of /: 0.2% of 1006.85GB
Memory usage: 5%
Swap usage: 0%
Processes: 40
Users logged in: 0
IPv4 address for eth0: 172.29.100.118
=> /usr/lib/linux-tools/6.18.54.1-microsoft-standard-WSL2 is using 100.0% of 96MB
* Canonical Workshop gives developers fast, composable, reproducible, and secure developer environments that are perfect for agentic workflows.
https://ubuntu.com/workshop
This message is shown once a day. To disable it please create the /home/afshaan/.hushlogin file.
afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:~$ basename /home/afshaan/report.txt
report.txt
afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:~$ dirname /home/afshaan/report.txt
/home/afshaan
afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:~$ realpath report.txt
/home/afshaan/report.txt
afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:~$ sudo runuser -u nobody -- whoami
[sudo: authenticate] Password:
nobody
afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:~$ last -n 5
Command 'last' not found, but can be installed with:
sudo apt install wtmpdb
afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:~$ sudo apt install wtmpdb
Installing:
wtmpdb


afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:
Processing triggers for libc-bin (2.43-2ubuntu2.4) ...
afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:~$ lastlog
Command 'lastlog' not found, did you mean:
command 'lastlog2' from deb lastlog2 (2.41.3-3ubuntu2)
Try: sudo apt install <deb name>
afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:~$ w
09:47:19 up 1:41, 1 user, load average: 0.05, 0.04, 0.00
USER TTY FROM LOGIN@ IDLE JCPU PCPU WHAT
afshaan pts/1 - Tue18 15:11m 0.03s 0.03s -bash
afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:~$ watch -n 2 date
afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:~$ pstree -p
systemd(1)─┬─agetty(300)
├─chronyd-starter(112)───chronyd(246)───chronyd(267)
├─cron(115)
├─dbus-daemon(116)
├─init-systemd(Ub(2)─┬─SessionLeader(389)───Relay(391)(390)
───ba+
├─SessionLeader(12507)───Relay(12514)(
12509+
├─init(9)───{init}(10)
├─init-watcher(3)
├─login(392)───bash(465)
└─{init-systemd(Ub}(11)
├─networkd-dispat(122)
├─packagekitd(12842)─┬─{packagekitd}(12843)
├─{packagekitd}(12844)
└─{packagekitd}(12845)
├─polkitd(2698)─┬─{polkitd}(2700)
├─{polkitd}(2701)
└─{polkitd}(2702)
├─rsyslogd(4682)─┬─{rsyslogd}(4683)
├─{rsyslogd}(4684)
└─{rsyslogd}(4685)
├─systemd(435)─┬─(sd-pam)(437)
└─dbus-daemon(11431)
├─systemd-journal(49)
├─systemd-logind(131)


afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:
└{init-systemd(Ub}(11)
├networkd-dispat(122)
├packagekitd(12842)─┬{packagekitd}(12843)
├{packagekitd}(12844)
└{packagekitd}(12845)
├polkitd(2698)─┬{polkitd}(2700)
├{polkitd}(2701)
└{polkitd}(2702)
├rsyslogd(4682)─┬{rsyslogd}(4683)
├{rsyslogd}(4684)
└{rsyslogd}(4685)
├systemd(435)─┬(sd-pam)(437)
└dbus-daemon(11431)
├systemd-journal(49)
├systemd-logind(131)
├systemd-resolve(69)
├systemd-udevd(92)
└unattended-upgr(303)──{unattended-upgr}(347)
afshaan@DESKTOP-94VFN85:~$ lscpu
Architecture: x86_64
CPU op-mode(s): 32-bit, 64-bit
Address sizes: 39 bits physical, 48 bits virtual
Byte Order: Little Endian
CPU(s): 12
On-line CPU(s) list: 0-11
Vendor ID: GenuineIntel
Model name: Intel(R) Core(TM) i7-8750H CPU @ 2.20GHz
CPU family: 6
Model: 158
Thread(s) per core: 2
Core(s) per socket: 6
Socket(s): 1
Stepping: 10
BogoMIPS: 4416.01
Flags: fpu vme de pse tsc msr pae mce cx8 apic s
ep mtr
r pge mca cmov pat pse36 clflush mmx fxsr